

**The fix is urgent,
and you need to ask
the devs without
sounding
controlling.**

A PROMPTING TECHNIQUE FOR EXACTLY THIS.
SWIPE →

UNSENT DRAFT, TAKE 4 🤨

Hey, sorry to chase, but I was
wondering if maybe



YOUR PROMPT

Write a Slack message asking the devs if the checkout issue is fixed.



you 9:41

Hi team! Hope you're crushing it! 🚀 Just circling back to align on the checkout page fix. Do we have visibility on the timeline? Keen to leverage any updates so we can close the loop by EOD. Thanks a bunch! 🙌

The chat assistant returns a very **AI-y, buzzword-y** message with a deadline request. Would you send that? Neither would we.

Add a **second part** to the prompt: how it should sound, and how long it should be.

YOUR PROMPT

Write a Slack message to the development team asking about the status of the checkout page slow loading issue.

Tone: friendly, warm, collaborative, confident.

Style: 1 to 2 sentences, conversational Slack style, direct ask for current status or ETA, end with a brief thanks.



Part one says what you need. Part two specifies how it sounds.



you 9:43

Hey team! 🙌 Checking in on the checkout page fix: is there a status or rough ETA?
Thanks so much!



dev team 9:47

Deploying the fix this afternoon! 🎉

Now the output is two sentences you'd happily send: a friendly check-in, a clear ask, a thank you. **Same request, different instructions**, entirely different message.

The **four levers**, for any message where tone could go wrong:



TONE

State it explicitly:
formal or casual, peer
or mentor.



AUDIENCE

Name who it's for;
depth and jargon
follow.



SAMPLE

Show a sample of your
writing to mirror.



LENGTH

Specify it: "2
sentences", "3
paragraphs", " $\leq$ 200
words".

They work in every chat assistant: ChatGPT,
Claude.ai, Gemini.

What tone and style **can do**, and what they can't:



Make the output **sound like you**.
Keep your messages **consistent**.



Reduce **factual errors**. A message can sound exactly like you and still be wrong.

Checking the facts is a separate skill (and a separate post).

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Status nudges, reminders, feedback asks: they all yield to this technique. Practise it in the free first challenge of **Write Better with AI: Prompting Foundations for Product Managers**.

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First challenge free 🧡



Send this to your colleagues who send you clearly AI-generated messages 📧